



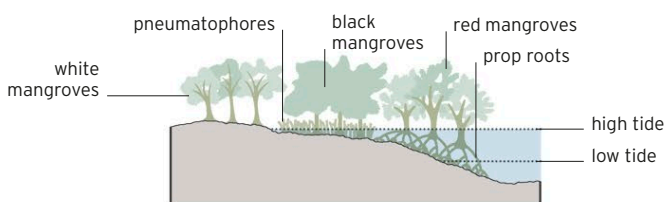
The Sundarbans

A vast stretch of mangrove forest and swampland lying on Earth's largest delta



MANGROVE ZONES

There are three main types of mangrove trees, with their own adaptations to particular tidal zones. Red and black mangroves, which live in the tidal zone, have specialized roots to absorb oxygen from the air. White mangroves, common in higher and drier areas, lack these adaptations.



Stretching more than 160 miles (250 km) across the Bangladesh–India border, where the Ganges Delta merges with the Bay of Bengal, the Sundarbans is a complex network of intertidal waterways, estuaries, mudflats, and islands.

Mangrove forest

The main habitat of the inland parts of the Sundarbans is seasonally flooded freshwater swamp forest consisting of broadleaf trees. The seaward side is dominated by the world's largest continuous tract of mangrove forest. One of the most common mangroves, known as *sundri* or *sundari*, is thought to have given the region its name.

An ecosystem rich in wildlife, the Sundarbans is home to many rare and threatened species, including the Bengal tiger and the Ganges river dolphin.

▽ VARIED DIET

As well as eating fish, the black-capped kingfisher varies its diet with shrimp and small crabs.

